Arkhipov, who was a reserve commander of the vessel, prevented a mutiny by taking guns from the seamen and throwing them into the sea. Eight members of the crew died within three weeks of the accident; more deaths would follow later. The incident became the basis for the plot of the 2002 Hollywood movie *K-19: The Widowmaker*, starring Harrison Ford.[3]

Captain Arkhipov survived the ordeal and was appointed chief of staff of the 69th Submarine Brigade. In the fall of 1962 he assumed command of the four Foxtrots, named B-4, B-10, B-36, and B-59, that were dispatched to Cuba. Originally they were to be part of a large flotilla of Soviet ships and submarines that the navy was planning to send to Cuba to establish a Soviet naval base. The flotilla was supposed to include two cruisers, two missile ships, two destroyers, and two submarine tenders. Besides the four Foxtrots there were to be seven Project 629 submarines, known to NATO as Golf-class subs, powered by diesel engines and equipped with missile launchers capable of delivering nuclear charges.

But on September 25, 1962, the navy changed its plans, considering that the dispatch of such an armada to Cuban ports "would attract the attention of the whole world and would not be to the advantage of the Soviet Union," as stated in the report. It was decided to send only the torpedo-armed Foxtrots, leaving the missile-armed Golfs at home. The navy was no longer planning to build a base in Cuba or to threaten the United States with submarine-based nuclear missiles but limiting itself to submarines with torpedoes that had a range of 19 kilometers. If anything, they would be there to protect cargoes going to Cuba.[4]

Arkhipov was well aware that the Foxtrots had weaknesses as well as strengths. Built at the Admiralty Shipyard of Leningrad (now St. Petersburg) as part of Project 641, they were relatively new additions to the Soviet navy, the first Foxtrot submarine having been commissioned in 1958. But they were designed to perform in the cold waters of the North Sea and ill-equipped for long transatlantic voyages in which Soviet submarines had never engaged. Their operating range was 20,000 kilometers above water and 11,000 kilometers if snorkeling, but their speed was relatively slow. The Foxtrots could not remain submerged and move quickly at the same time. They could develop a speed up to 16 knots (30